

Stay Interview

QUESTION GUIDE

Use these questions one at a time. Listen more than you talk. A stay interview with no follow-up does more damage than no stay interview at all.

THE QUESTIONS

1. What makes you want to come to work each day?

Tip: Listen for intrinsic motivators. Absence of these is a warning sign.

2. What keeps you here?

Tip: Different from question 1. This surfaces what the person values most right now.

3. When did you last think about leaving? What prompted it?

Tip: The honest answer tells you exactly where the risk lives.

4. What would make your work more meaningful?

Tip: Surfaces unmet needs around purpose. Often reveals job crafting opportunities.

5. What does a great day at work look like for you?

Tip: Reveals what energises this person. Compare to their current reality.

6. Is there anything that gets in the way of your best work?

Tip: This often surfaces what people will not say directly.

7. Do you feel recognised? What does recognition mean to you?

Tip: Recognition means different things to different people. Do not assume.

8. How do you feel about your growth and development here?

Tip: Perceived lack of growth is one of the top reasons people leave.

9. What could your manager do more of, or less of?

Tip: Frame it as feedback for the relationship, not a complaint form.

10. If you could change one thing about your role, what would it be?

Tip: By now trust is built. This answer is often the most honest of all.

AFTER THE CONVERSATION

Write up your notes within 24 hours. Identify one action you will take. Tell the person what you heard and what you plan to do. Follow through.